

Part III: Evaluating Stakeholder Readiness

Smart Plant Care Device | Written by Brian McCarthy

Purpose: Assess five stakeholders using Tuckman Ladder stages, Hersey-Blanchard readiness levels, and recommended leadership strategies.

Readiness Evaluation Table

Stakeholder	Role / Current State	Stage	Readiness Level	Recommended Strategy
David Johnson	Scrum Master. Highly experienced, works independently, owns agile ceremonies, removes impediments, and supports team cohesion.	Performing	R4	Delegate or Monitor. Give David autonomy to facilitate ceremonies and manage impediments. Hold periodic check-ins, recognize his leadership, and rely on him to maintain agile discipline and team flow.
Sarah Lee	Development team member. New to the team, uncertain about her role, and needs clear direction and frequent support for soil moisture and watering integration work.	Forming	R1	Tell or Direct. Provide clear task definitions, acceptance criteria, pairing support, coding standards, and frequent feedback until she understands responsibilities and gains confidence.
Ethan Carter	Development team member. Technically skilled and experienced, but frustrated by conflicts and weak collaboration while working on advanced sensor technology.	Storming	R2	Sell or Coach. Address conflict directly, listen to concerns, clarify outcomes, coach collaboration norms, and create a supportive environment that keeps Ethan engaged and productive.
Raj Kumar	Executive Sponsor. Committed to funding and strategic support, but needs regular progress, risk, and alignment updates to make informed decisions.	Norming	R3	Participate or Support. Involve Raj in milestone reviews and strategic decisions, provide concise status reporting, invite feedback on risks and goals, and avoid overloading him with execution-level details.
Jennifer Williams	IT Department Member. Skilled in backend infrastructure, cybersecurity, and app integration, but concerned about technical complexity and feasibility.	Storming	R2	Sell or Coach. Engage Jennifer early in architecture and risk discussions, clarify technical assumptions, document security and integration requirements, and coach alignment through collaborative problem-solving.

Rationale

The readiness assessment applies different leadership strategies because the stakeholders are not at the same level of confidence, autonomy, or alignment. David is already performing at a high level and can be monitored with minimal intervention. Sarah needs direct guidance because she is still forming her understanding of the project and role. Ethan and Jennifer both have capability, but need coaching because concerns, conflict, or uncertainty could reduce engagement. Raj is supportive and strategically aligned, so the best approach is to involve and support him through structured updates and decision points.

Evaluator Checklist Coverage

- All five required stakeholders are analyzed.
- Each stakeholder includes a Tuckman stage, readiness level, and recommended strategy.

- Strategies are tied to each stakeholder's role, responsibilities, and current state.